

More are learning outside a classroom

Homeschooling, ‘unschooling’ draw interest in Mass.

By Maria Probert
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

When Jace Rossignol was in fifth grade, he was breezing through seventh grade math and scored on an 11th grade reading level in the state-wide MCAS exam. His elementary school could not accommodate him academically, but his mother worried about bullying if she moved him up a few grade levels to middle school.

Jace, now 13, struggled to connect with his peers. He is an emotionally mature kid, has long hair and likes to wear big earrings and bright colored clothes. He also has the physical stature of an 8- or 9-year-old. Home-school groups did not suit his academic interests and the family wasn’t sure what to do.

Then they found North Star, a center for self-directed learning based in Sunderland where students who are registered as homeschoolers take classes, hang out, volunteer, or get one-on-one tutoring, based on the subjects and classes they want to pursue or on their academic goals.

North Star’s educational approach, sometimes called “unschooling,” is based on a type of home-school movement started in the

1970s that is guided by students’ interests. Critics question the lack of structure in unschooling and whether students get a well-rounded education or are prepared for higher education. But, supporters say it fosters critical thinking

SCHOOL, Page A10

In small R.I. city, a growing fear amid crackdown on immigration

By Edward Fitzpatrick and Christopher Gavin

GLOBE STAFF

CENTRAL FALLS, R.I. — Every time Myriam Maya takes a walk in her Central Falls neighborhood, there are two things she makes sure she brings: her cellphone and her ID.

ICE could try to detain her, she said, even though the Colombia native has been a US citizen since 2019.

“Now, there is fear everywhere,” said Maya, 69, who came to the United States from Colombia 25 years ago. “In all the years I have lived in this country, I have never seen people hiding and being as fearful as they are now.”

As the Trump administration ratchets up a deportation machine fueled by billions of dollars, arrests by masked Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents have left New England communities reeling, torn families apart, and threatened to disrupt the region’s workforce.

Though Rhode Island’s neighborhoods have not seen the same level of ICE activity as Worcester and Boston, fear has gripped Central Falls, a densely packed 1.2-square-mile home to more than 22,000 residents.

While it is Rhode Island’s smallest city, Central Falls is the state’s only majority-Latino city, with the highest percentage of Latinos of any community in the state, according to 2020 Census data. With side streets packed with triple-decker houses, the main street is filled with the smells of Colombian food from La Casona and Mexican food from Tuxpan Taqueria.

The small city has produced big stars, such as

CENTRAL FALLS, Page A6

‘We didn’t get there, but we have a very good chance of getting there.’

PRESIDENT TRUMP, speaking after his meeting with Russian President Vladimir Putin

Summit ends without deal

Trump, Putin offer no details, take no questions

By Michael Birnbaum, Cat Zakrzewski, Francesca Ebel, and Catherine Belton
WASHINGTON POST

President Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin ended a high-stakes meeting on Friday to end the bloodiest European war since World War II. It was a historic visit that boosted the Russian leader but did not immediately deliver the peace in Ukraine that Trump sought.

In the end, the two leaders stopped their meetings earlier than planned and offered no concrete details on any progress they had made, taking no questions from reporters, a rare moment of restraint by Trump, who usually loves talking to the press.



SERGEI SUPINSKY/AFP VIA GETTY IMAGES

Protesters gathered outside the US Embassy in Kyiv on Friday.

It was an abrupt end to a historic meeting that started with pomp, pageantry, and warmth between the two leaders.

“There’s no deal until there’s a deal,” Trump told reporters, speaking alongside Putin in what was intended as a news conference where the leaders took no questions — often a sign that a meeting has gone worse than expected.

“We had an extremely productive meeting, and many points were agreed to,” Trump said. “There are just a very few that are left. Some are not that significant. One is probably the most significant, but we have a very good chance of getting there. We didn’t get there, but we have a very good chance of getting there.”

The high-stakes talks held the potential to end the Kremlin’s war in Ukraine and shape

SUMMIT, Page A7



DOUG MILLS/NEW YORK TIMES

President Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin greeted each other Friday at Joint Base Elmendorf-Richardson.

D.C. chief retains power — for now

After court clash, White House steps back earlier order

By Lindsay Whitehurst and Stephen Groves
ASSOCIATED PRESS

WASHINGTON — The Trump administration on Friday reversed course and agreed to leave the Washington, D.C., police chief in control of the department, while Attorney General Pam Bondi, in a new memo, di-

rected the District’s police to cooperate with federal immigration enforcement regardless of any city law.

The order from Bondi came after officials in the nation’s capital sued Friday to block President Trump’s takeover of the Washington police. The night before, his administration had escalated its intervention into the city’s law enforcement by naming a federal official as the new emergency head of the department.

The attorney general’s new order represents a partial retreat for the Trump administration in the face of

intense skepticism from a judge over the legality of Bondi’s earlier directive that sought to put the police force under the full control of the federal government. But Bondi also signaled the administration would continue to pressure D.C. leaders to help federal authorities aggressively pursue immigrants in the country illegally, despite city laws on the books that limit cooperation between police and immigration authorities.

In a social media post Friday evening, Bondi criticized D.C. Attorney

D.C., Page A6

With a boost from e-bikes, these families prefer pedal power

By Spencer Buell
GLOBE STAFF

Bikes with massive buckets, where toddlers huddle together, buckled amid backpacks and bags of groceries.

Bikes with long seats, hauling tweens as they cradle saxophones or hockey gear.

Custom 3D-printed accessories, blinking LED strips, mounts that can lug stuff weighing hundreds of pounds.

Glance at the growing network of protected bike lanes in the Boston area, and you’ll see it all.

As electric-assisted bikes improve — and morph, adapt, and proliferate — parents say they are finding it easier than ever to do most anything that once required four wheels on just two. For this crew, minivans are out. E-cargo bikes are in.

A decade ago, when Amanda Rychel was rolling up to the day-care drop-off in Somerville atop a cargo bike, she said, “I was an oddity.”

But other parents were intrigued. She never got stuck in Somerville’s often snarled traffic, never had to circle the block for a parking space. All her kids’ supplies seemed to travel just fine — no trunk necessary.



BARRY CHIN/GLOBE STAFF

Cody Dunne Scott of Cambridge transported his kids — Azira, 3, Keoni, 6, and Zenna, 8 — by bicycle after camp at the Morse Elementary School in Cambridge.

“A lot has changed in 10 years,” said Rychel, a 51-year-old project manager. “Now there’s a whole fleet of cargo bikes picking up their kids.”

Like many bike-focused parents in the area, fa-

E-BIKES, Page A10

Gaza’s water access has been progressively strained over the nearly two years since Israel launched its offensive. **A4.**

Erin strengthened into a hurricane as it approached the northeast Caribbean, prompting forecasters to warn of possible flooding and landslides. **A2.**

A wrongful death lawsuit has been filed on behalf of a woman who died in the Gabriel House fire. **B1.**

Brockton Hospital and its parent organization are slashing service lines and about 80 positions. **D1.**



Sun day

Saturday: Mostly sunny. High: 75-80. Low: 66-71.

Sunday: Some clouds. High: 88-93. Low: 63-68.

Sunrise: 5:53 Sunset: 7:44 Comics and Weather, **D4-5.**

Obituaries, **C9.**

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